

**PAPER DELIVERED BY HONOURABLE JUSTICE M.B.
DONGBAN-MENSEM, CFR, JP⁺, HONOURABLE PRESIDENT,
COURT OF APPEAL, AT THE PRE-SWEARING-IN
INDUCTION PROGRAMME FOR NEW SENIOR ADVOCATES
OF NIGERIA, HELD ON WEDNESDAY 25 SEPTEMBER, 2024,
AT THE TRANSCORP HILTON HOTEL, ABUJA.**

PROTOCOLS:

It is with profound honour, humility and gratitude to God Almighty that I stand before this esteemed gathering today as the facilitator of this distinguished induction program for new Senior Advocates of Nigeria, centered around the theme: *Excellence in the Practice of Law*.

I sincerely appreciate the Body of Senior Advocates of Nigeria (BOSAN) for demonstrating its commitment to excellence and the advancement of the legal profession. This induction program serves as a refresher course to adequately prepare and equip the new Senior Advocates with the requisite knowledge, skills, and values necessary to excel in their esteemed new roles. It highlights the importance of mentorship and collaboration, through the guidance of experienced Senior Advocates. The newly appointed Senior Advocates will no doubt benefit from these invaluable insights ensuring continuity and consistency in the application of legal principles.

As we delve into the heart of today's discussions, I am privileged to introduce the sub-topic of our discourse: *"Understanding the culture and demands of continuous excellence at the Inner Bar: The Perspective from the Bench"*.

I acknowledge the fact that this topic has been addressed on numerous occasions, but it is essential to continuously reiterate these duties and obligations expected of Senior Advocates. Their importance cannot be overstated and the commitment to upholding them remains vital to the integrity of the profession.

The topic seeks to explore the highest standards of professionalism, discipline and ethical conduct required for sustained excellence within the legal profession, particularly at the Inner Bar. Through the lens of the Bench, you will gain key understanding into the expectations, responsibilities and evolving dynamics that define success and integrity in the practice of law in Nigeria. This conversation will not only provide a deeper understanding of the legal culture but will also highlight the continuous demands placed on advocates as well as the need for unwavering commitment to justice and the Rule of Law.

THE RANK: SENIOR ADVOCATE OF NIGERIA

The Inner Bar in Nigeria, symbolized by the rank of Senior Advocate of Nigeria (SAN), represents the pinnacle of professional accomplishment, signifying both a mastery of the law and a commitment to ethical advocacy. The conferment of the title is more than a ceremonial honour, it is a public trust. Members of the Inner Bar are expected to uphold the highest standards of legal practice, act as stewards of the profession's ethical codes and set a benchmark for junior advocates. It is one of the highest honours in the legal profession, denoting not only exceptional expertise, and legal acumen, but also a lifetime of dedication to the ethical principles and values that guide the administration of justice. The role of a Senior Advocate extends beyond personal achievement to the responsibility of shaping the legal profession and guiding its evolution, thereby setting benchmarks for excellence in advocacy.

This esteemed title serves as a benchmark for professional brilliance, encouraging lawyers to strive for distinction in their practice. Senior Advocates enjoy certain privileges such as; sitting within the Bar of the Court, precedence in Court hearings, and wearing silk gowns, underlining the respect and esteem accorded to them.

EVOLUTION OF THE TITLE; SENIOR ADVOCATE OF NIGERIA

The introduction of English Law into Nigeria in 1863 marked the beginning of the country's legal system. The Supreme Court of Her Majesty's Settlement of Lagos was established in April 1863, with the

power to admit legal practitioners. However, despite similarities in qualification requirements, the reward system differed between Nigeria and the UK. Although the SAN title was first conferred in 1975, on two distinguished Nigerian legal practitioners, however, its history predates this milestone, rooted in the struggle for Nigerian legal practitioners to attain the esteemed Queen's Counsel rank.

Chief F.R.A. Williams and Dr. N.B. Graham-Douglas, the first Senior Advocates of Nigeria (SAN), made significant and lasting contributions to the Nigerian legal profession. As pioneers, they set the standard for legal excellence, inspiring future generations with their exceptional expertise and dedication. Through landmark cases and innovative legal arguments, they played a crucial role in shaping Nigeria's jurisprudence, leaving an indelible mark on the country's legal landscape.

Their leadership and mentorship guided younger lawyers, contributing to the growth and development of the profession. They advocated for legal reforms, promoting justice and fairness in the Nigerian legal system. Demonstrating the highest standards of professionalism and ethics, they served as role models for the legal community. Their legacy continues to inspire and influence the legal profession, ensuring their contributions remain relevant and impactful.

EXCELLENCE IN THE INNER BAR

From the perspective of the Bench, continuous excellence at the Inner Bar is crucial to the effective functioning of the judicial system. As the ultimate custodians of justice, the Bench relies on Senior Advocates to be more than skilled lawyers; they must be ethical leaders, mentors and standard bearers of professionalism. The practice of law is not merely a profession; it is a noble calling. It demands firm commitment to ethical principles, unshakeable integrity and unrelenting dedication to the pursuit of justice.

Excellence in the profession encompasses a range of qualities, including Integrity, intellectual rigor, analytical precision and effective communication.

The conduct of a Senior Advocate both in and out of the courtroom, reflects not only on themselves but also on the legal profession as a whole. He is often seen as a bridge between the law and society, responsible for advocating the highest standards of justice while inspiring confidence in the legal system.

In **OGOALA V. THE STATE (1991) 4 NWLR (PT. 175) 509**. The brief facts as follows;

The appellant and one other with threats of violence with a cutlass to Mr. Olumuyiwa Ayanbule and Mrs. Adebola Phillips the occupants of a Peugeot 504 car with registration No.LA 9534 MB property of Mr. Ayanbule robbed Mr. Ayanbule of the car by driving out the occupants of the car and in company of another drove off the car. They were later involved in a collision as they raced off in the car. In an attempt to escape from the scene of the collision, the appellant was arrested. As he was being beaten for the collision, Mr. Ayanbule and Dr. & Mrs. Phillips arrived at the scene in another car identified him as an armed robber who had robbed them of the car, involved in the accident. He was taken to the police station from where he was charged to court on information. He made a confessional statement Exhibit B to the police.

That after the trial, the appellant was convicted. He appealed to Court of Appeal and his appeal was dismissed. Still dissatisfied with the judgment, he further appealed to the Supreme Court contending inter alia that there are material contradictions in the case of the prosecution, that the identification parade was necessary to link the appellant with the offence and that the plea of alibi was not properly considered.

The Court stated that;

“Learned counsel has cited some authorities that are neither relevant nor support the facts of this case. Authorities cannot hang in the air without a legal base. The legal authority is based on the facts on which the authority is predicated. A plethora of authorities which are unrelated and immaterial to

the facts presented before a court cannot alter the findings of facts based on the evidence before the court.” Per OLATAWURA, JSC.

However, maintaining excellence at the Inner Bar is no easy task. The demands placed on Senior Advocates are multifaceted and ever-evolving. You must adapt to new legal challenges, legislative reforms and societal changes, while upholding the integrity of the legal profession. Excellence is not a destination but a continuous journey, one that requires constant reflection, discipline and growth.

The culture of excellence is built on several pillars such as:

- ***Ethical Leadership:*** SANs are expected to lead by example in ethical behavior. Integrity is the foundation upon which everything else rests. You are expected to exhibit a firm conviction in upholding the highest ethical standards, even when it is difficult or unpopular. It is paramount to strictly adhere to the Rules of Professional Conduct, avoiding conflicts of interest, and maintaining confidentiality. As senior members of the legal community, you bear a responsibility not just to your clients but to the integrity of the profession itself. Your conduct should inspire confidence in the legal system, reinforcing the belief that justice is accessible, transparent and impartial.
- ***Legal Expertise:*** Senior Advocates are required to possess in-depth knowledge of the law, particularly in areas of specialization. Intellectual curiosity is essential. The law is a dynamic and ever-changing field, and to stay ahead, one must stay abreast of jurisprudential developments. This involves engaging in continuous learning, attending seminars, workshops, and conferences, and reading widely on various subjects.
- ***Contribution to law reform and policy development:*** Senior Advocates are expected to have a unique perspective on the workings and development of the law thereby providing invaluable insights to policymakers.

- **Effective Advocacy:** This is a critical skill for Senior Advocates and it must be effectively utilized. This involves persuasive communication, strategic thinking, and the ability to present complex arguments in a clear and concise manner. It also requires a deep understanding of the judicial process and the ability to navigate complex procedural issues. The Court in **BORISHADE V. N.B.N LTD, (2007) 1 NWLR (PT. 1015) 217**, stated that *“advocacy is an art of skill and tact...”* – Per DONGBAN-MENSEM, PCA.

In performing this skill, Senior Advocates must remember their duty to their clients and the Courts. Their obligation is to adhere to the tacit principles that regulate the relationship with client and the Court. In the case of **MAGNUSSON V. KOIKI (1991) 4 NWLR (PT. 183) 119**, the Court expounded on the importance of effective advocacy as follows:

“Advocacy is a very serious affair; and pertinent persuasive advocacy more so. While it is generally said that cases are never won at the address stage, strong, dynamic, purposeful and persuasive advocacy goes a long way in tilting the balance of the case in favour of the hardworking advocate as against the lazy, drab, long drawn and apparently lifeless opposing advocacy.

Advocacy is not the easiest job in the legal profession, nay in the lawyer's professional life. It is a very difficult job. It is a very technical aspect of the legal profession which counsel must handle with utmost care and seriousness. This is because the rules of the game are not only slippery but versatile, and to some extent burdensome overreaching, particularly when the attendant tricks are at their best on the floor of the court. In performing the art of advocacy, counsel owe both their clients and the court a duty to bring out all relevant authorities in support of the case of their clients. They have a duty to assist the court in a material way to arrive at a just and fair decision in the matter before it. In as much as they have a right to withhold an issue from the court based on the ethical rules of

secrecy of communication between counsel and client, they have an abiding duty to bring out their best in advocacy and this they can do by citing to the court relevant authorities to beef up or embellish the facts. And in the context of the instant case, counsel ought to have called the attention of this court to the most relevant paragraphs, indicating the factual situation intermittently with the available authorities. That this was not done in the best tradition of courtroom advocacy is rather unfortunate and sad.” Per TOBI, JCA.

DOS OF ORAL ADVOCACY:

- ***Preparation and mastery of facts of a case:*** Senior Advocates are expected to enter the courtroom fully prepared, having a thorough understanding of both the facts of the case and the applicable law. For example, in complex commercial litigation, a SAN should be able to explain financial transactions clearly offering the court relevant precedents and statutory provisions. Being able to anticipate the Bench’s questions or concerns is a hallmark of superior oral advocacy.
- ***Clarity and Brevity:*** An effective oral advocate presents arguments succinctly, ensuring that his core points are clear and accessible to the Bench.
- ***Respect for the Bench and Opposing Counsel:*** Senior Advocates must show firm respect for the court and their opponents. They should avoid unnecessary confrontations, interruptions or dismissive remarks. A Senior Advocate should always maintain composure, addressing arguments respectfully and focusing on presenting a cogent legal response.
- ***Adherence to Procedural Rules:*** It is essential that Senior Advocates comply with court procedures and rules, from filing documents on time to addressing the court properly with phrases such as “My Lord” or “Your Lordship”, adhering to established courtroom decorum and protocols demonstrates professionalism.

DON'TS OF ORAL ADVOCACY

- ***Over-reliance on Jargon or overly Complex Language:*** while SANs are highly knowledgeable, their arguments must remain accessible to both the Bench and the audience. Overloading an argument with legalese or unnecessarily complex language is counterproductive.
- ***Misrepresentation of Facts or Authorities:*** Any deliberate attempt to misrepresent the facts of a case or the law is unethical and severely undermines a SAN's credibility. For instance, citing a precedent out of context or altering the factual matrix of the case for strategic purposes not only damage the advocate's reputation but also erode trust in the judicial process. In ***MAGNUSSON V. KOIKI (1991) 4 NWLR (PT. 183) 119*** - The Court held thus;

"In advocacy, it is not the quantity of the materials rushed out to the court that matters, but it is the quality. It is no use parading an index of legal authorities, which have no bearing with the factual situation of the case before the court. In Ogoala v. The State (1991) 2 NWLR (Pt.175) 509, Olatawura, J.S.C. said at page 535:

"Learned counsel has cited some authorities that are neither relevant nor support the facts of this case. Authorities cannot hang in the air without a legal base. The legal authority is based on the facts on which the authority is predicated. A plethora of authorities which are unrelated and immaterial to the facts presented before a court cannot alter the findings of facts on the evidence before the court."

I entirely agree with the learned Justice of the Supreme Court. He is very correct. But even if I had cause to disagree with him, I shall have no choice to take a contrary view. The rules of stare decisis are clear. They are stringently and tightly so." Per TOBI, JCA (As He Then Was).

- ***Disrespectful or Unprofessional Conduct:*** Senior Advocates must never display contempt for the Court or their opponents. Raising one's voice in anger, arguing aggressively with the Bench, or using derogatory language towards opposing counsel or witnesses are examples of behavior that tarnishes the dignity of the profession.

WRITTEN ADVOCACY (DOS)

- ***Precision and coherence:*** written submissions should be precise, well-structured and free from ambiguity. In brief writing, you should clearly identify the issues at hand, present a logical flow of argument and cite relevant case law and statutory provisions without ambiguity. This enables the court to understand the argument and its foundation clearly. See ***F.S.B.INT.BANK V. IMANO (NIG) LTD (2000) 11 NWLR (PT. 679) 620*** - The Court stated that;

*"I cannot overlook the rather cumbersome nature of respondent's brief. I find it needlessly verbose and prolix. The 'introduction' together with 'statement of facts' gulped a total of nine pages while the three issues for determination required 31 pages to put across the narrow issues in real controversy between the parties. A brief submitted on behalf of each party to an appeal, as the term readily suggests, is a precis or an abridgment of the relevant submissions a disciplined counsel would wish to put across for consideration by the court demonstrating lucidly and succinctly why his contentions should be preferred rather than those of the opposing counsel. Counsel should caution oneself and be reminded that good advocacy, like writing a good brief, does not accommodate unnecessary repetition since it has long been established that repetition does not improve an argument. There is yet a new book on the subject of brief writing by Hon. Justice Niki Tobi, JCA, titled *The Brief System in Nigerian Courts* (1999 Ed.) which I warmly commend to serious-minded appellate court practitioners if they are to excel in this aspect of their legal*

practice. A good brief should be readable, concise but comprehensive, leaving no stone untouched in relation to the issues placed before the court which must be adequately addressed. In contrast, a bad brief bore the court and sometimes, even a painstaking Judge, may be eluded in eliciting the matter in controversy to the chagrin of counsel's client. It is therefore hoped that in the interest of the court and the client's case counsel should appreciate that presentation of a good brief is an indispensable asset to successful appellate legal practice." Per ACHIKE, JCA (As He Then Was)

- ***Adherence to Rules of Court and format:*** SANs are expected to follow the court's specific formatting rules, including page limits, font size and citation styles.
- ***Incorporation of sound Legal Analysis:*** SANs must provide a thorough and well-reasoned analysis of the law in their submissions. For example, when writing your Notice of Appeal, you should methodically deconstruct the lower court's decision, providing a well-supported argument as to why the decision should be overturned or upheld. See **OKOLO V. U.B.N. LTD (1998) 2 NWLR (PT. 539) 618** – The Court noted that;

"I will pause to observe that counsel has inundated and adorned the appellants' brief with a galaxy of legal authorities but not even one was discussed as a locus classicus nor accorded any in depth consideration in order to elicit its similarity with the facts and circumstances of the case before the court. Such in depth discussion of a case may encompass several rationes decidendi and undoubtedly, it becomes the responsibility of counsel placing reliance on the case to identify the specific ratio or rationes in the case that he intends to rely on. Had this burden on counsel been painstakingly discharged he would readily have appreciated that this case is hopelessly irrelevant to the instant case,

having regard to the pleaded facts and evidence led at the trial.” Per ACHIKE, JCA (As He Then Was)

WRITTEN ADVOCACY (DON'TS)

- ***Overly Lengthy or unfocused submissions;*** Courts value clarity and conciseness in written submissions. Rambling, overly long submissions that fail to get to the heart of the matter are likely to be disregarded.

In *NWARATA V. EBOKA* (2005) 10 NWLR (PT. 933) 241, the Court cautioned against unfocused submissions as follows:

“My Lords, a cursory look at the statement of defence and counter-claim filed by the respondent discloses a most inelegantly drafted court process I have ever seen. The statement of defence is nothing but a narration of distorted joggled facts. It is not only undecipherable but completely incomprehensible to the extent that I have to ask myself whether legal drafting, as a course, is no longer in vogue or has been cancelled in the Nigeria Law School. Needless to say that drafting is an important part of advocacy. In other words importance of drafting skill cannot be over emphasized. Where pleading has been so distorted and joggled as in this case, i.e. statement of defence, it would not only be difficult but also impossible to adequately defend the client involved. Pleading, I want to believe, is the foundation of a good advocacy, where the foundation is faulty nothing, and absolutely nothing could be pleaded on it.” Per MUNTAKA-COOMASSIE, JCA (As He Then Was)

- ***Omission of Key Authorities or Misquoting the Law:*** Failing to cite relevant precedents or worse, misrepresenting the law is a serious breach of professional ethics.
- ***Improper Language or Tone:*** Written submissions should always maintain a respectful tone. Unduly harsh criticism of the court or opposing counsel is unprofessional and can detract from the substantive issues at hand. For example, calling the decision of a

court incompetent without justification is unprofessional which may diminish the advocate's standing in the eyes of the Bench. See *EDOSOMWAN V. EREBOR (2001) 13 NWLR (PT. 730) 265*, the Court cautioned against the use of improper language and tone when addressing the Judge as follows:

"I have said it many times that counsel should not pass unfounded aspersions on Judges because they do not have the opportunity to reply. I have read the ruling a couple of times and I do not see the slightest justification for the attack. Good advocacy lies in counsel presenting his case on the merits in the most effective traditions of our profession. Good advocacy does not lie in attacking the Judge.

For counsel to accuse the trial Judge of taking over as counsel is a most serious castigation, which I did not expect from counsel.

The mere fact that a Judge does not accept the submissions of counsel should not expose him to such unguarded attack. I do hope E the Supreme Court will not be treated to the same "meal" when this case goes on appeal. It is my hope that counsel will be more temperate and civil in their language, especially on Judges. Judges are a helpless lot. Let counsel sympathise with our state of helplessness." Per TOBI, JCA (As He Then Was)

COMMUNITY SERVICE

Excellence in law is deeply connected with community service, especially for Senior Advocates of Nigeria (SAN). As leaders in the legal profession, Senior Advocates are expected to demonstrate exceptional expertise, dedication, and contributions to the legal profession and the community.

The conferment of the rank of SAN is made pursuant to the Legal Practitioners Act 207, Section 5 (1). Some of the factors considered for conferment, are the candidate's significant contribution to the development of the legal profession. Key expectations from Senior Advocates of Nigeria include:

- *Pro Bono* Services: SANs are expected to give back to the society, including offering free legal representation to indigent clients and marginalized communities
- Public Interest Litigation: Advocating for policy reforms, human rights, and social justice through strategic litigation
- Legal Education and Awareness: Conducting workshops, seminars, and public lectures to promote legal literacy and awareness
- Mentorship Programs: Guiding junior lawyers, law students, and young people in underserved communities
- Community Development Projects: Supporting initiatives that address poverty, healthcare, education, and infrastructure.

By engaging in these community service activities, Senior Advocates can make a positive impact on society, enhance public trust and confidence in the legal profession, and uphold the integrity of the judiciary and justice system.

SENIOR ADVOCATES AS GUARDIANS OF LEGAL ETHICS

Legal ethics is the foundation upon which our profession is built. It is the moral compass that guides our actions, shape our decisions, and the professional standards that distinguishes the Senior Advocates from others. As legal practitioners, we are custodians of the law, entrusted with the responsibility of upholding justice and ensuring that the rule of law prevails. The Rules of Professional Conduct provide the framework for ethical behavior among lawyers in Nigeria. Senior Advocates, in particular, are expected to adhere strictly to these rules, demonstrating exemplary conduct in their professional and personal lives. You must resist the temptation to compromise ethical standards.

Permit me to emphasize the critical importance of discipline, decorum and adherence to ethical standards as leaders of the profession. The Bench has, on occasion witnessed some regrettable incidents involving some members of the Inner Bar, which is a cause for concern. There have been instances where Senior Advocates have acted unprofessionally, including walking out of Court in anger or engaging in

conduct that could be seen as attempts to undermine or blackmail the Bench.

We have also witnessed a growing number of petitions submitted to the National Judicial Council (NJC) by Senior Advocates making frivolous, serious and at times grievous allegations against the Bench. This has caused significant concern and reflects a troubling level of disrespect towards the Judiciary, a behavior that is completely unacceptable for any legal practitioner particularly those of the Inner Bar. The importance of Senior Advocates adhering to the Rules of Professional Conduct and maintaining the highest ethical standard cannot be overemphasized. As leaders in the legal community, your behavior sets the tone for the profession, and it is your duty to uphold the dignity, respect and decorum expected in the administration of justice.

Key ethical principles for Senior Advocates include:

- Integrity: SANs must maintain unwavering commitment to honesty, transparency, and fairness.
- Confidentiality: Senior Advocates must protect client confidentiality, avoiding unauthorized disclosure.
- Conflict of Interest: SANs must avoid conflicts of interest, ensuring impartial representation.
- Competence: Senior Advocates must demonstrate expertise and stay updated on developments in jurisprudence.
- Professional Courtesy: SANs must exhibit respect, civility, and cooperation towards colleagues, judges, and clients.
- Accountability: SANs must be accountable for their actions, accepting responsibility for mistake.

EXEMPLARY MASTERY OF THE LAW

Mastery of the law is fundamental to our professional excellence. Senior Advocates are expected to demonstrate not only comprehensive understanding of the law but also the ability to apply this knowledge

creatively and effectively. Their legal arguments must reflect a deep comprehension of jurisprudence, case law, statutes and constitutional principles. They are entrusted with the most complex and high-stakes cases, where their expertise can influence judicial precedent and legal reform. It is therefore necessary to stay abreast of jurisprudential developments, develop expertise in specialized areas, analyze complex legal issues, and apply the law with precision and wisdom.

Continuous learning involves engaging in ongoing legal education, seminars, workshops, and conferences. This enables us to stay updated on judicial decisions, legislative changes, and emerging trends. Jurisprudential awareness requires us to analyze complex issues, evaluate evidence, and develop persuasive arguments.

Specialization allows us to develop expertise in specific areas of the law, enhancing our professional reputation and effectiveness. The benefits of mastery of the law are numerous.

However, challenges persist. These include keeping pace with rapidly changing laws and regulations, balancing specialization with broad knowledge, and applying legal theory to practical problems require dedication and perseverance. To overcome these challenges, there is need to prioritize continuous learning and professional development, engage in peer review and knowledge sharing, contribute to law reform and policy discussions to mentor the next generation of lawyers.

MENTORSHIP

As Senior Advocates of Nigeria (SAN), you have attained the pinnacle of our profession, earning recognition for your expertise, integrity, and dedication. However, your elevation to this esteemed rank is not solely a personal achievement, but also a demonstration to the guidance and support you received from your predecessors and peers. Mentorship is a vital component of our professional development. It plays a crucial role in fostering a culture of continuous excellence within the legal profession. Mentorship involves knowledge sharing, experience, and wisdom with junior lawyers, empowering them to navigate the complexities of our profession.

Effective mentors provide guidance, encouragement, and constructive feedback, helping mentees develop essential skills, build confidence, and cultivate a strong work ethic. As Senior Advocates, you have a responsibility to give back to the profession by investing your time and effort in mentoring younger lawyers. By so doing, you not only repay the debt you owe to your own mentors but also contribute to the growth and development of our profession. A culture of mentorship fosters a sense of community and camaraderie, promoting collaboration diversity, and inclusion within the legal profession. This will undoubtedly enrich the profession, thereby bringing fresh perspectives and innovative ideas to the forefront.

INTROSPECTION

Amidst the demands of our practice, it is essential to pause and reflect on our personal and professional lives. Introspection, a deliberate examination of our thoughts, feelings, and actions, is a vital tool for lawyers, enabling us to cultivate self-awareness, identify areas for improvement, and enhance our overall well-being. By examining our strengths and weaknesses, we can optimize our performance, capitalize on opportunities, and address potential pitfalls. This self-reflection also fosters emotional intelligence, empowering you to navigate complex relationships with clients, colleagues, and judges.

Introspection enables lawyers to confront and manage stress, anxiety, and burnout. The legal profession is inherently demanding, and neglecting our mental health can have devastating consequences. Through introspection, we can recognize early warning signs, develop coping strategies, and prioritize self-care. It promotes ethical awareness and decision-making. By examining our actions and their consequences, we can refine our moral compass, ensuring that our conduct aligns with the highest standards of professionalism.

CONCLUSION

The Bench and the Inner Bar are partners in the pursuit of justice. The culture and demands of continuous excellence at the Inner Bar are grounded on the values of integrity, leadership and lifelong learning.

From the perspective of the Bench, Senior Advocates must exemplify the highest standard of legal behavior and ethical practice. Your roles are not confined to the Courtroom but extends within the legal profession and the society at large.

The benefits of this induction program therefore extend beyond the individual participants, positively impacting the broader legal community. By elevating standards of professionalism, BOSAN's commitment to excellence is evident in this program, which is carefully crafted to address the complexities of modern legal practice. Its dedication to organizing this induction, ensuring that the new Senior Advocates are well-prepared to navigate the intricacies and challenges of the profession is highly commendable.

The success of this program stands as a testament to BOSAN's leadership and vision. As the legal landscape continues to evolve, initiatives like this remain vital in shaping the future of the legal profession.

Thank you and God bless you all.

Honourable Justice M.B. Dongban-Mensem, CFR, JP⁺
President, Court of Appeal